



FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

ICRHK receives a maternal and newborn advocacy grant to support the acceleration of maternal & newborn SDGs in Kenya.

6th February, 2025, (Mombasa, Kenya) International Centre for Reproductive Health -Kenya (ICRHK) is thrilled to announce that it has been awarded a MNH advocacy grant from the Gates Foundation. This funding will support advocacy efforts towards Every Woman Every Newborn Everywhere interventions under the project name (**Okoa Mama na Mtoto Initiative**) across counties in Kenya with high burden of maternal mortality and morbidities.

ICRHK, a renowned independent, local nongovernmental organization (NGO) in research and interventions in public health, including sexual reproductive health, will manage a diverse consortium of predominantly local organizations including: Ushiriki Wema, Options Consultancy, Lwala Community Alliance, Wanahabari, and Professional institutions including KMTC, Kenya Obstetrical and Gynecological Society (KOGS), women-led grassroots organizations such as Shina Foundation, Women Engaged in Development, Fountain of Hope, FANIKISHA, and Ollwi.

“Advocacy for Maternal and Newborn Health is a shared responsibility. It demands a collaborative effort from all stakeholders, including Governments, civil society organizations, healthcare providers, and communities. We at ICRHK are committed to working alongside these partners to ensure every mother and newborn in Kenya has the best possible chance at a healthy life,” says Dr Susan Ontiri, Country Director ICRH-Kenya

While Kenya made progress towards the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs), it did not achieve targets 4 and 5, focusing on reducing child mortality and improving maternal health. Now, under the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), Kenya faces a similar challenge. With five years remaining to achieve the SDG targets for 2030, the country is not on track. This indicates a continued need for focused efforts to address these critical health issues.

Achieving the SDGs, especially reducing maternal and neonatal deaths, is impossible without engaging county-level decision-makers. ICRHK, together with the consortium partners, will be leading this front to ensure last-mile efforts and effective, localized interventions at the county and national fronts.



ICRH Kenya

INTERNATIONAL CENTRE FOR REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH - KENYA

*Improving sexual and reproductive health
through research, training and adapted interventions*

About ICRHK:

International Centre for Reproductive Health Kenya (ICRHK) is a renowned organization dedicated to sexual and reproductive health research and public health interventions in Kenya. Established in May 2000, ICRHK is registered as a local non-governmental organization and has since emerged as a leading force in the field.

ICRHK aims to contribute to improved health status of communities by conducting high-quality research, designing and implementing innovative, evidence-based, and cost-effective interventions capable of influencing public policy and practice, and capacity building in the field of public health, including sexual and reproductive health in Kenya.

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